EMPRESS OF ART

Kiran Nadar, *72*
Chairperson, Kiran Nadar Museum of Art; Trustee, Shiv Nadar Foundation

FEW KNOW THAT KIRAN NADAR, one of the most renowned names in Indian art circles, is also an international-level bridge player, who has brought India many laurels. She first started playing at the age of 10 with her family. "When I started playing competitive bridge, I had no idea that there was something like a world championship. People rated me as having very good bridge skills. So, when I started to play, I didn't find the game tough, I found it mentally stimulating," says Nadar.

That's how it has always been for Kiran Nadar, who founded the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) in 2010. She is always up for a good challenge. "Most people retire at a certain age, but I don't feel the need to," she says. That never-say-die spirit reflects in her pursuit of art as well. It all started with collecting art pieces for her home. "I realised that there was a shortage of places where people could go and appreciate art. I felt it's important to democratise art." A connoisseur and collector herself, Kiran's vision has led to KNMA becoming home to a collection comprising over 12,000 artworks. It has grown to be a platform like no other in India, boasting collaborations with various international centres such as the Museo Nacional Centro de Arte Reina Sofía (Madrid), The Metropolitan Museum of Art (New York), Tate Modern (London), Musée Des Arts Asiatiques (Nice) and Musée Guimet (Paris).

"Art is a legacy I'd like to leave for many years past my lifetime," says Kiran. And she counts her husband as a key source of support through that quest. "I'd never have been able to do the museum without his support."

At 72, Kiran is far from done. Her next project is a state-of-the-art KNMA centre near the New Delhi airport. The space is being developed as a hub for visual arts and will feature exhibitions and performances. "I may slow down a bit, but I'll still see that it is completed in the best possible way." ■

-Shelly Anand

ACCOMPLISHMENT

At 72, Kiran Nadar, the founder of one of the most prominent art centres in India, continues to be as passionate about her work as when she first started



HARDIK CHHABRA

MUM'S DAUGHTER

"I get my dynamic personality from my mother and maternal grandmother. My mother died at 86 and was very active till the end"

SPORTS BUFF

A sports buff, she is a fan of M.S. Dhoni and Roger Federer